

Chad Gaydos,
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Skillsoft



Skilling me softly

We get the lowdown on how Skillsoft helps companies accelerate employee skilling

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Can you tell us a bit about Skillsoft?

Gaydos: Skillsoft is the global leader in e-learning that provides high-quality, innovative, cloud-based e-learning and performance support resources. We have been in business since 1998 since then have deployed solutions in 160 countries and in 129 different languages. We have been enabling organizations to achieve competitive advantages through our superior enterprise-wide knowledge and skills. Our client base includes the top companies from multiple verticals who rely on us for a host of different areas including compliance, technology, development, business skills and leadership skills.

How is Skillsoft different from the competition?

Gaydos: Our depth and breadth in e-learning really sets us apart. If you look at the way our products are created, we really have a huge value proposition with our multiple modality. We call

it Watch, Read, Listen, and Practice. So these really help us differentiate. Also, the way that we create our content, and then deliver it through a learning experience platform, Percipio. The reason that Skillsoft has got to where it is today is by focusing on delivering beautiful technology and beautiful content to customers. The rich experiences ultimately deliver outcomes and help with retaining talent and driving efficiency.

Is the content created by Skillsoft?

Gaydos: The content is created in house, but there are some parts that we collaborate with companies on. For example, Cognizant here in India. We have worked with them on certain topics around technology and development.

What are the revenue generating verticals?

Gaydos: Well, we are in multiple verticals, but our services are very big. Our service providers include Cognizant, TCS, HCL here and global names such as IBM or Accenture. That is an example of a really big vertical for us. We are also very big in the United States, in the government vertical, and that is a big focus for us here in India too.

Are there any unique challenges in the APAC region?

Gaydos: Languages would be. We are creating a focus in each region based on

the demographic, based on where we think the micro vertical focus should be. So, there is a lot of opportunity for us in South East Asia. At the same time, we want to be in the right market, with the right product, at the right price, to be able to capture that business to business customer from our side. India is an incredibly important market in terms of our content business. It has a huge population below the age of twenty-five. Now, we have consolidated our position in India to be in the enterprise and the corporate b2b market. We are working with partners to expand into governance and also into education. We see a lot of opportunity there, and we also see the need to upskill and reskill talent that is out there. We need to leverage the right kind of partnership to reach that at scale. The market is so big. The traditional verticals that we have captured here, on the corporate side are very strong, but we want to get into new markets, and we want to get deeper into government and education.

How do you keep pace with rapid changes in technologies?

Gaydos: We work directly with our customers. We scan the market. We look at what other competitors are offering. Mostly we focus on what the customer needs are. So, our teams are able to try to think ahead. Not only about what our customers need now, but also anticipate the needs for the future.

Can you tell us how Skillsoft is handling automation?

Gaydos: So, when we talk about automation, we lead the content market with bleeding edge technologies. If you think about automation and what is going on with AI and data science, it is a very important topic for our customers. There is a gap in what the traditional models of learning could deliver, and what is required by corporates. We really fit into that space because we can provide the soft skills combined with the bleeding edge technologies like data science, design thinking or quantum computing. We can also provide the soft skills with e-books, audiobooks, mentoring and practice labs. There is a full spectrum of corporate needs around how we address things like AI. 